

Juliette Gudknecht

Federal Data Scientist, Steward, and Analyst

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SUMMARY

Data scientist and federal data-governance professional (M.S. Applied Statistics) with 4+ years turning large public datasets into validated, Section 508-compliant dashboards, automated QC pipelines, and clear national reporting.

EXPERIENCE

Data Analyst (Education Program Specialist) 2024 – Present

U.S. Department of Education, Office of Special Education Programs (OSEP)

- One of the key data stewards and subject-matter experts for IDEA Section 618 reporting across six national data collections; the data informs services for 8M+ students with disabilities and an IDEA program directing about \$15 billion in formula funds to states each year.
- Lead the IDEA Discipline (2023–24, 2024–25) and Personnel (2024–25) collections and their public static tables, including QC, validation, and Section 508-accessible displays.
- Built Python automation for data-quality checks and reusable 508-compliant reporting templates now adopted across the office.
- Co-authored the four most recent OSEP Fast Facts and contributed to the IDEA Annual Report to Congress, turning Section 618 data into accessible public data stories.
- Represent OSEP on two federal data-governance boards (EDFacts Data Governance Board; OPEPD Data Literacy Workgroup) and oversee 15 grants worth \$20M+ per year, including two national data centers.
- Co-delivered a keynote to 1,200 attendees at the OSEP Leadership Conference.

Founder & CEO 2021 – Present

Autism & Neurodivergency Advocacy Association

- Founded and lead a 501(c)(3) nonprofit advancing neurodiversity through research, education, and international partnerships.

Data Analyst Intern 2021 – 2024

U.S. Department of Education, Institute of Education Sciences

- Ran latent profile analysis on restricted-use NAEP data (Mplus) characterizing the out-of-school reading habits of 810 autistic 8th-graders; presented as a research poster.

Data Science / Analytics Intern 2022

NASA, Goddard Space Flight Center

- Built an R and Google Data Studio dashboard with ARIMA time-series forecasting for social-media analytics; the dashboard remains in use by the Hubble Space Telescope team.

Data Science Intern 2021

Geisinger

- Built regression models across 90,000 patient records studying autism and co-occurring genetic conditions, and produced COVID-19 forecasting for operational planning.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages & Query: Python, R, SQL, SPSS, Java

Machine Learning & Statistics: Predictive modeling, random forest, neural networks, time series (ARIMA), regression, latent class / profile analysis

AI: Generative AI (certified), Machine Learning with Python (certified), prompt engineering, AI-assisted analytics

Platforms & BI: Power BI, Looker / Google Data Studio, Excel

Data Practices: QC & validation automation, data governance, Section 508 accessible dashboards, data visualization, data storytelling

EDUCATION

M.S., Applied Statistics – Columbia University 2023

B.S., Physics & Data Science – Bloomsburg University 2021

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

- Zajic, M. C., & Gudknecht, J. (2024). Person- and identity-first language in autism research. *Autism*. (36 citations)
- Zajic, M. C., Gudknecht, J., & McIntyre, N. S. (2025). Characterizing the special education goals of autistic students. *Exceptional Children*.
- Kapp, S. K., & Gudknecht, J. (2025). The strengths of speech divergence in autistic people. *Infant and Child Development*.
- Google Scholar: 50 citations, h-index 3.